
LEONARD FRANCIS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Scrum Master (SAFe) experience delivering complex projects in process automation, data analytics, API suite development, and risk management. Expert in project governance, risk and dependency mapping, budget forecasting, and executive stakeholder management within Agile and Waterfall environments. Proficient in using JIRA and Confluence for project tracking and management.

SKILLS

- Program Planning and Execution
- Agile / Scrum / SAFe / Kanban (Flow)
- Lean and Six Sigma principles
- Enterprise Technology Environments
- Experienced with Software development lifecycle
- JIRA / Confluence / MS Project
- Program Budgeting and Forecasting
- Risk & Dependencies management

WORK HISTORY

Senior Scrum Master, 02/2022 - Current

TD Bank Group – Toronto, ON

- Facilitated Scrum/SAFe ceremonies (sprint planning, backlog refinement, daily stand-ups, reviews, retrospectives) to ensure program governance and delivery consistency.
- Partnered with Product Owners and external partners to develop program roadmaps, release schedules, and dependency tracking, enabling on-time releases.
- Oversaw cross-functional coordination between development, QA, deployment, and support teams, improving release management efficiency and reducing defects.
- Enhanced throughput by 25% through improved cross-functional collaboration across technology, operations, and business teams.

Project Manager / Senior Scrum Master, 05/2018 - 02/2022

Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce – Toronto, Canada

- Led three Agile PODs delivering credit-card and banking modernization projects under strict regulatory oversight, achieving 100% adherence to delivery timelines.
- Coached teams on Scrum and Kanban, increasing predictability and reducing sprint rollover by 30%.
- Managed Agile delivery lifecycle across PODs using Jira, MS Project, and Confluence to track financials, dependencies, and key milestones.
- Designed executive dashboards for leadership to track key project KPIs, improving strategic visibility.
- Supported budgeting and financial forecasting by aligning delivery capacity with program roadmaps, reducing forecast variance.

Advisory Application Developer, 08/2015 - 05/2018

CIBC – Toronto

- Collaborated with cross-bank teams on ECCO program to enable secure, large-scale data transfers, ensuring compliance with program governance and delivery quality standards.

Senior Business Analyst 04/2015 - 08/2015

International Financial Data (IFDS) – Toronto

- Produced reusable program knowledge assets and reporting dashboards, improving executive-level program performance reporting and decision-making.

Senior Project Manager, 08/2004 - 09/2013

Mashreq Bank

- Directed multiple retail banking transformation projects improving customer acquisition by 25%.
- Embedded Lean Six Sigma methodologies across initiatives reducing operational waste by 15%.
- Acted as a Six Sigma Blue Belt driving key projects in regulatory compliance and risk management.

EDUCATION

Master of Science: Information Systems
University of Colorado - Boulder, Colorado

Diploma: Software Engineering
Canadian Business College - Toronto, ON

BBA: Commerce, 08/1998
Karachi University - Karachi, Pakistan

CERTIFICATIONS

- Project Management Professional – PMI
- SAFe Advanced Scrum Master - Scaled Agile INC
- Certified Professional Scrum Master (PSM) Scrum.org
- Certified Pega Business System Architect v8.5 - 2021.
- Certificate in Advanced Data Science and Predictive Analytics: Data Science from York University - September 2020
- Certified Scrum Master from Scrum Alliance since 2018
- Certified Business Analysis Professional from the International Institute of Business Analysis (Membership ID 114178) - 2017
- Microsoft Certificate number F238-3215 Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate: SQL Server - 2015